

My friend thinks theirs no point in boycotting AI (for environmental sake) Is he right?

Posted by u/Significant-Can7651 • • 0 points • 0 comments

So I think I'll start off by saying, I have a friend who is very intelligent. However, it gets annoying how often he gloats on it. 😏

He's had some views that I don't agree with but besides that we haven't really argued about our beliefs before. Recently, I expressed how I don't like AI and mentioned I had done a presentation about the effects of AI on the environment and the billions of liters of water the data centers use annually. Basically, his response was, we might as well get with the times and just use it. He goes on to talk about how the phone I had was mined unethically, the cloths I have on were probably made in a sweatshop, and the car I drive also contributes to the carbon footprint. So what's the point in fighting AI if the environment is already doomed? I'm not sure If he said this to deflect taking responsibility for the fact that he does use it and doesn't care to stop or if these are his genuine beliefs. Despite his intention what he said was true. There are many ways I contribute unknowingly or even knowingly to the destruction of the environment. But can't I at least try to do better? Shouldn't we want to do what we can to support the eco-system and limit the amount of damage we contribute to it? Anyways I'm just curious what others view points are on this. Because I have been debating this concept for a while. And it doesn't help that the only opinions I've really heard from people in my life are the same (my friends opinion). I don't know if it's even exactly what he said that bothered me or the fact he thought I was a complete idiot for thinking otherwise. Also please tell me if I'm in the wrong in this situation. Just came here to rant and learn.

Comments

u/thekaz • 1 points • 2025-12-10 05:05 UTC

When talking about "the point" it's similar to taking about "meaning" or "purpose". It's a subjective and personal decision for each person to make for themselves. There's a lot of different ways to arrive at those decisions and many of these processes rely on portable objective measures like scientific research or logic. But, even if the method is objective and logically sound, the ultimate ability to make a decision about what is "the point" is a personal and subjective decision to be made by each person for themselves.

You are actually saying that for you, it's worth it to boycott AI. He is saying that for him, it's not worth it to boycott AI. These two statements are fundamentally compatible and there is no inherent conflict. The only conflict that can occur is if you start attempting to dictate what he should do, or if he starts attempting to dictate what you should do.

Then, the debate turns into a discussion of autonomy, not AI and the environment.

Your insistence on you OR him being right is what's causing the conflict here. The two of you aren't even talking about the same thing, both of your viewpoints are valid and can coexist. Fundamentally there is no conflict

u/Pure_Penalty_3591 • 1 points • 2025-12-10 04:34 UTC

I think all of the arguments you presented, from both you, are right.

u/Haunting_Try8071 • 1 points • 2025-12-10 04:31 UTC

I guess I'm confused on what you want to do and what you expect it to do?

u/Significant-Can7651 • 1 points • 2025-12-10 04:35 UTC

What?! I'm confused by what you mean. What is the it you're referring to?

u/Haunting_Try8071 • 1 points • 2025-12-10 04:40 UTC

Your title, what's it going to do and what do you expect it to do?